av-launcher user guide

A menu-bar tray launcher for the fleet's local web-server apps: pick a **network interface** and **port**, **Start/Stop** the server, **Open** the web UI, and leave it in the **system tray**.

If you're using `srt-router`, `flock` or `RFutils` as a desktop app, this is the shell you're looking at.

If the server won't start on a clean Mac, read this first

The released builds are now Developer ID-signed and notarised, so this should no longer bite anyone who downloads the `.dmg` or `.pkg`. It is still the first thing to check if you built the app yourself, or if you are running a download from before that changed — because **for an unsigned `.app` that bundles helper binaries, approving the app does NOT unquarantine its payload, and the helpers are SIGKILLed silently.**

That is exactly this app's shape — a tray app wrapping an embedded server binary. The failure mode is nasty:

- the app launches and **looks completely fine**;
- the server **never starts**;
- **there is no visible error.**

This is the first thing to check, not a bug in the server. Clearing the quarantine attribute on the whole bundle is the usual fix:

```
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine "/Applications/<the app>.app"
```

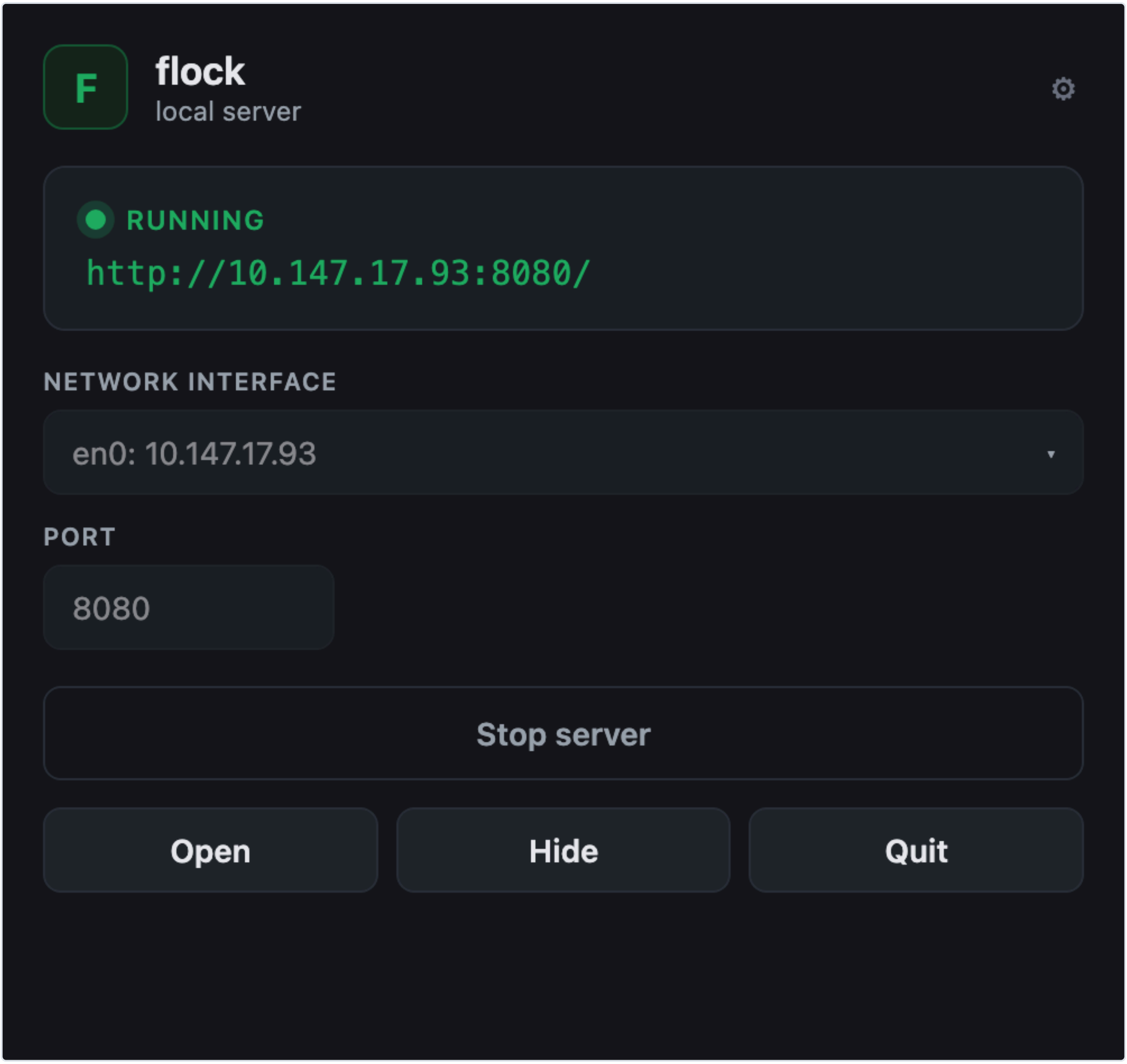
Consuming apps ship signing notes of their own — see each app's `launcher/SIGNING.md`.

What has and hasn't been tested

The Rust backend compiles and the panel UI has been exercised **via its mock backend**. **The full tray app has not been run end-to-end against a live server on the target machine.**

Given the above, that gap matters: **the untested path is exactly the one where the Gatekeeper problem shows up.**

Using the panel



The same shell, themed per app — srt-router and RFutils get their own name, icon and colour, and behave identically.

The URL under the RUNNING badge is **the address the server is actually bound to**, not a template. If it says `127.0.0.1` when you expected a LAN address, the interface selector is the thing to change — copy that URL to reach the app from another machine.

Control	Does
GUI Interface	which network interface the server binds
Port	which port
Start / Stop	run or kill the server
Open	open the web UI in your browser
Hide	back to the tray — the server keeps running
Quit	**stops the server and exits**

Hide and Quit are different. Hiding leaves the server running; quitting kills it. If you close the panel expecting the app to keep serving, use Hide.

Interface and port

The **GUI Interface** dropdown lists every bindable IPv4 interface plus **All interfaces (0.0.0.0)**.

- **A specific interface** → the server binds that IP, and the URL shows that IP.
- **All interfaces** → the server binds `0.0.0.0`, and the URL shows your **primary non-loopback IP** so the link is still clickable.

> **"All interfaces" means the server is reachable from your whole network.** Whether that's appropriate depends on the app you're launching and what it can do — several of these fleet apps have no authentication. Pick a specific interface if you want it contained.

Your interface and port choice is **remembered** between launches, in the OS app-config directory.

If your port silently reverts to the default, the saved settings file is missing or unreadable — every failure there falls back to the default without an error.

Starting and stopping

- **Pressing Start when it's already running does nothing harmful** — it just reports the current status. It does **not** restart the server.
- **If the server exits on its own**, the panel notices the next time it refreshes status, not instantly.
- **Stop and Quit kill the process outright.** There's no graceful shutdown, so an app that writes state on exit may not get the chance. Stop the server before unplugging anything it was writing to.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause
App opens, server never starts, no error (macOS)	**The Gatekeeper quarantine trap** (If the server won't start on a clean Mac, read this first). Check this first.
Server starts then immediately stops	Often the working directory: several apps read relative paths (`state/routes.json`, `data/registry.json`) and fail if started elsewhere. That's a launcher-config issue, not a server bug.
Port reverted to the default	The saved settings file is missing or unreadable; it falls back silently (Interface and port).
URL shows an IP I didn't pick	You chose "All interfaces", so it shows your primary non-loopback IP to keep the link clickable (Interface and port).
Others on the network can reach it	"All interfaces" binds `0.0.0.0` (Interface and port).
Closed the panel and the app kept serving	That's Hide. Quit stops it (Using the panel).
Start did nothing	It was already running (Starting and stopping).
The app lost unsaved state on Quit	Quit kills the child; there's no graceful shutdown (Starting and stopping).

See also

- API.md — the launcher contract and the command surface
- adding-an-app.md — wrapping another app in this shell
- DEVELOPING.md — building it